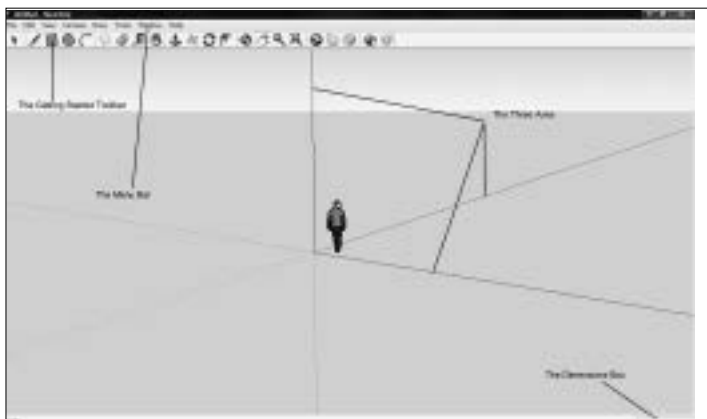




A first look at the Google SketchUp Workspace. Notice the three axes

Upon entering Google SketchUp, you are presented with the familiar Windows toolbar organisation. Also present is a toolbar filled with icons, for quick access to common tools (called the Getting Started toolbar). At the bottom right is a field box, which will be your primary guide to dimensional accuracy while modelling. On the same line, to the left, there's text which helps you with the usage of the selected tool. On clicking a tool, it tells you the ideal next step on the tool's usage.

1.2.1 The Menu Bar

The Google SketchUp interface follows the pattern of the regular Windows Menu Bar with the following submenus and options:

- **File:** Apart from standard file options such as New, Open, Save, Save As and Exit, the File Menu also offers Import and Export options. These allow you to acquire files designed using other software and use Google SketchUp files in other programs, respectively.

Import: The import option allows you to accept not just standard image formats (JPEG, BMP, GIF, PNG, etc.) but also files created in other 3D modelling software like AutoCAD and 3DsMAX.

Export: Contains a variety of options to produce two and three dimensional images from your Google SketchUp graphic for use in external programs.